The world in brief

Catch up quickly on the global stories that matter

Photograph: U.S. Central Command Public Affairs

Donald Trump said hostilities with Iran “have terminated” ahead of a deadline that would have required lawmakers’ permission to continue the war after 60 days of fighting. His administration has claimed that the ceasefire “pauses” this clock. Democrats have argued the law doesn’t allow for such a stop, noting that American forces remain deployed.

Earlier Mr Trump dismissed a new proposal from **Iran** for negotiations with **America**. The treasury warned shippers of sanctions if they pay tolls to Iran for passage through the **Strait of Hormuz**. Mr Trump has vowed to keep a blockade in place. After a turbulent week in oil markets the price of Brent crude, the global oil benchmark, fell to around $108 a barrel on Friday.

Mr Trump said he would increase **tariffs** on cars from the EU to 25%, from 15% currently, and accused the bloc of “not complying” with a trade deal struck last year. Earlier he said he will remove tariffs on Scotch whisky, an apparent gesture of goodwill following King Charles’s state visit to America.

Apple reported its best-ever earnings for the first quarter of the year, with revenue of $111bn, 17% higher than a year ago. iPhone sales were strong, and revenue from services such as cloud storage

beat analysts' expectations. The company is on a roll with devices, but is a laggard in the AI race. In September **Tim Cook**, its boss for 15 years, will be replaced by John Ternus, who oversees hardware.

The **Trump administration** imposed new sanctions on Cuban officials and entities supporting the island's security apparatus. The new rules also widen America's pressure campaign by targeting people or financial institutions who do business with sanctioned individuals. The move comes as the island is reckoning with worsening fuel shortages and blackouts.

Spirit Airlines is reportedly preparing to shut down after struggling to secure a bailout from the Trump administration. The low-cost carrier filed for its second bankruptcy last year amid growing competition and a failed merger with JetBlue; rising energy prices have caused additional strain. On Friday Mr Trump said he would help Spirit "if we can" but "America comes first".

Figure of the day: 14m, the daily number of barrels of oil trapped by the closure of the Strait of Hormuz. Read the full story.

Photograph: Alamy

Nasdaq’s fast track

Large firms can now join America’s leading index for tech stocks at lightning speed. From Friday Nasdaq will let companies join its NASDAQ 100 index within 15 trading days of their initial public offerings if their market capitalisation puts them in the index’s top 40. Previously, they had to wait at least three months.

Nasdaq wants to take advantage of an expected series of mega-IPOs. SpaceX, a rocket firm owned by Elon Musk, might list at a valuation as high as $2trn—which would make its IPO the largest ever.

Joining the NASDAQ 100 would benefit SpaceX, too. The company’s shares would then be bought automatically by funds that track stockmarket indices, thereby lowering its cost of capital. But speedy entry, and other changes—including a reduction in the percentage of shares that index members must make publicly available—have raised worries that Nasdaq is too eager to pander to Mr Musk and his fellow tech moguls.

Photograph: Getty Images

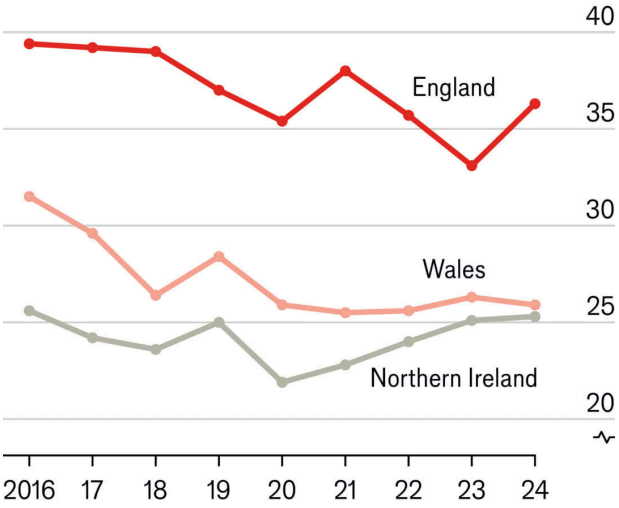
Britain is trying to clean up its rental market

Friday brings sweeping legislative reform to privately rented homes in England, which account for nearly 5m of the country's 25m dwellings. The Renters' Rights Act abolishes fixed-term tenancies (typically 12 months long), replacing them with contracts that roll over indefinitely. No-fault evictions, in which landlords can oust tenants without explanation, are now banned, too. Landlords will need to provide a valid reason, such as selling the property or unpaid rent.

Proponents say the changes give tenants much-needed security. But they may constrain supply by making it harder to raise rents. Landlords will not be able to let their properties for higher than the advertised price—ending bidding wars that have helped push up rents in recent years. Existing tenants will be able to challenge annual rent reviews at a tribunal. Many tenants believe landlords have been fleecing them. But according to one measure of affordability by Britain's Office for National Statistics, rent is cheaper now as a proportion of tenants' income than it was in 2016.

Bring down the house

Britain, private renters, average rent as % of median household income



Source: ONS

Photograph: Getty Images

America’s oil majors are down but not out

ExxonMobil and Chevron, two American oil giants, published quarterly reports on Friday. Despite soaring oil prices triggered by conflict in the Gulf, accounting rules mean that the short-term losses show up on the books before the extra profits from high prices do. As a result, ExxonMobil’s first-quarter net income plummeted 46% year on year to $4.2bn, while Chevron’s plunged by 37% to $2.2bn. Though both firms did slightly better than analysts had forecast, their results are still likely to drag down profits for the broader S&P 500 energy sector year on year. The closure of the Strait of Hormuz has reduced Exxon’s production in the Middle East by about 6%.

But there are two bright spots. First, the spoils of higher prices will soon show on balance sheets. Second, both firms have made big bets in America’s Permian shale basin and Guyana’s offshore patch, both reliable wells of earnings when faraway fields turn turbulent.

Photograph: AP

Stumbling on the runway: “The Devil Wears Prada 2”

All right everyone, gird your loins: “The Devil Wears Prada” is back. Twenty years ago Andy (Anne Hathaway) left *Runway*, the world’s most prestigious fashion magazine, and Miranda Priestly (Meryl Streep), its tyrannical editor-in-chief. Now a respected investigative journalist, she is brought back to shore up the magazine’s reporting after *Runway* goes viral for the wrong reasons.

The first film delighted viewers, in part, by inverting expectations: prepped to loathe the vapid, materialistic world of high fashion, they were presented with a spirited defence of it. “The Devil Wears Prada 2” is concerned about the present and future of journalism, but is less convincing in the case it tries to make for it. It argues that magazines like *Runway* are essential—“the last piece of wood floating next to the Titanic”, as Miranda puts it—yet concedes they have lost most of their cultural clout. So when the cast struts triumphantly in their couture, it feels all trousers, no talk.

Illustration: Sandra Navarro

Daily quiz

We will serve you a new question each weekday. On Friday your challenge is to give us all five answers and tell us the theme. Email your responses (and your home city and country) by 1700 BST on Friday to . We'll pick three winners at random and crown them on Saturday.

Friday: Which female tennis player took part in the Battle of the Sexes match against Bobby Riggs in 1973?

Thursday: Which buildings in Malaysia were the world's tallest from 1998 to 2004?

Some men are born mediocre, some men achieve mediocrity, and some men have mediocrity thrust upon them.

Joseph Heller